



ANDROID

What Lies Ahead?

With the Android OS making its presence felt in smartphones, tablets and the tube, the question of, "What next?" seems inevitable. The *LFY* team got in touch with leading Android smartphone vendors to learn more about how secure the Android OS is, the key brand differentiators in terms of apps, and more.

Android smartphones have today outflanked rivals and turned into kings in the mobile space. According to research firm IDC, Android-powered smartphones outpaced iPhone sales 4:1 during the second quarter of 2012. Latest statistics by Gartner also reveal that while the Android OS reigned supreme in the global smartphone terrain in Q2 with a 64.1 per cent market share, Apple's iOS stood second at 18.8 per cent, with Nokia's Symbian at 5.9, and RIM's BlackBerry at 5.2 per cent. As Android registers a robust growth, smartphone vendors, too, are clamouring to ride the Android bandwagon and cater to the changing consumer trends.

Android: What's next?

Industry pundits are gung-ho about the fact that Google's Android OS will not just be confined to the key domains of smartphones, tablets and television, but will become more personalised in future and make its way into home appliances. According to them, the day is not far when consumers will be able to control their household gadgets using their Android-based devices. S N Rai, co-founder and director of Lava Mobile, a homegrown mobile phone brand that recently launched its Intel-based Android smartphone Xolo X900, explains, "In future, the need for complete customisation would grow and Android will become smarter, and understand user requirements; it will converge these into

all household devices and personal gadgets. Google has taken up an interesting initiative to make this vision feasible by launching what is called the Android @Home project. This aims to formulate a service in which the Android OS will act as a remote control to all your home devices. Soon, you will have the power to manage the security, geysers, lights, DVD players, etc, at your home with your Android smartphone."

With all the customisation options available in the Android ecosystem, Android could soon dominate the world economy, feels Shashin Devsare, executive director, Karbonn Mobiles, a brand that has recently made a foray into the tablet market and launched the Jelly Bean-powered Smart Tab 1. "In the earlier stages of the computing boom, Microsoft took the world by storm. Android is all set to repeat that feat. Sectors like banking, sports and human communication will be taken over by the Android ecosystem in the days to come. The patronage of Google will take Android to the next level of human communication and will touch us in every way possible," says Devsare.

Safeguarding the future

Even though Android smartphones are currently basking in the glory of an enormous market share, experts feel the survival of the Android OS lies in its security system. The latest figures by Kaspersky Lab state that there has been a conspicuous increase in Android malware, and the number